UK Medicine Trade: Trend Analysis, 2022–2026

Exports, imports and the gap

Average over the 12 months to Jul 2026

Exports a month	Imports a month	Trade gap a month
£1,703m	£1,976m	-£273m

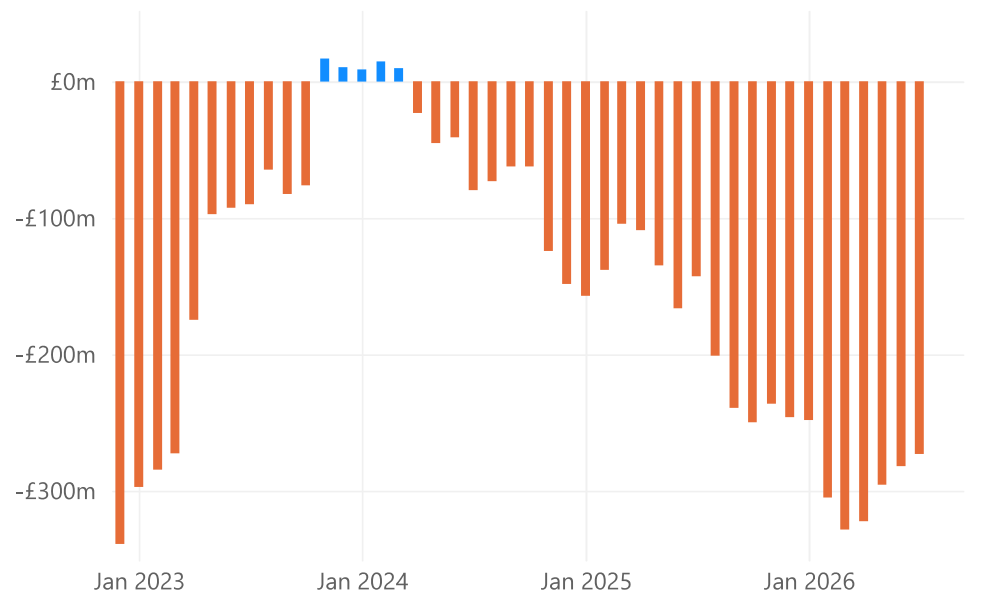
UK medicine exports fell from £1,884m to £1,703m a month

12-month average, Dec 2022 to Jul 2026. Peak: £1,975m, Apr 2023.



The gap closed in 2023, but is back to -£273m a month

Exports minus imports, 12-month average. Below zero, imports are higher.

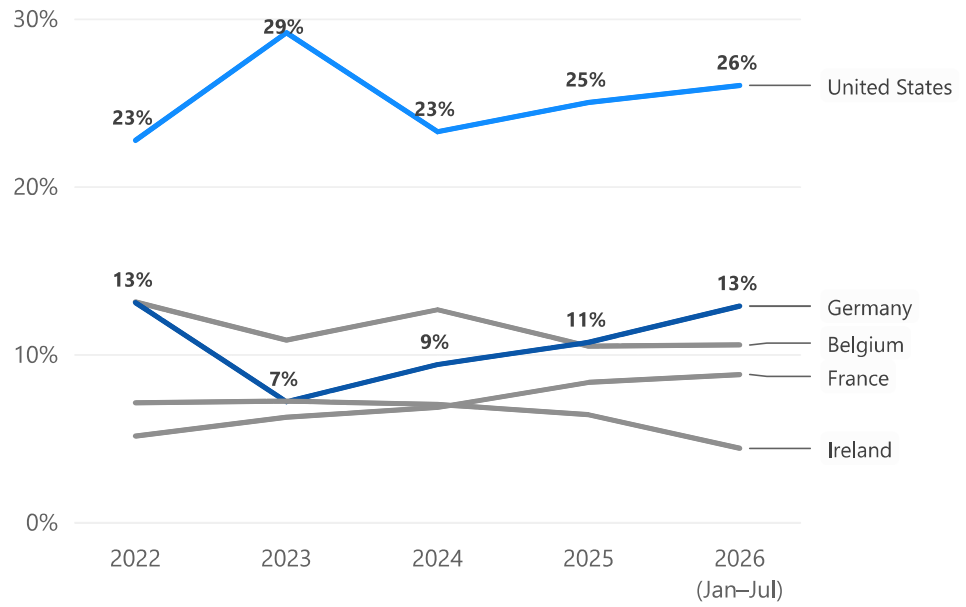


Source: HMRC Overseas Trade in Goods Statistics, pharmaceutical products (HS chapter 30), Jan 2022 to Jul 2026. Not adjusted for inflation.
Includes eight months of unusually large imports from Israel (£1.02bn). Without them the gap is -£261m a month at Dec 2022, not -£339m, and still rises £278m in 2023, not £349m.

Buyers and suppliers

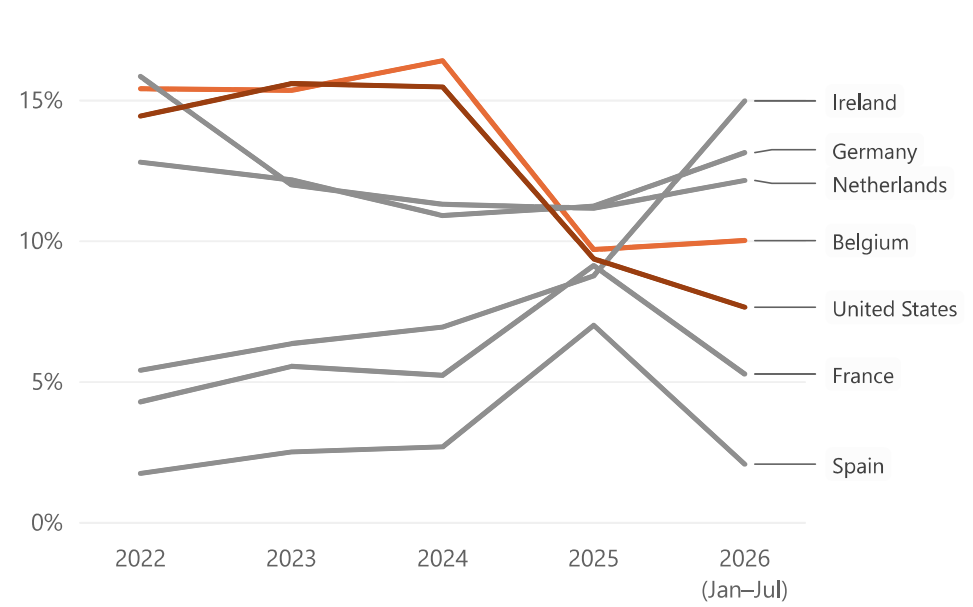
In 2023 the US share jumped to 29%, while Germany's fell to 7%

Share of export value, top 5 buyers. 2026 is Jan to Jul.



Belgium's and the US's import shares each fell over 6 points in 2025

Share of import value by country of dispatch. 2026 is Jan to Jul.

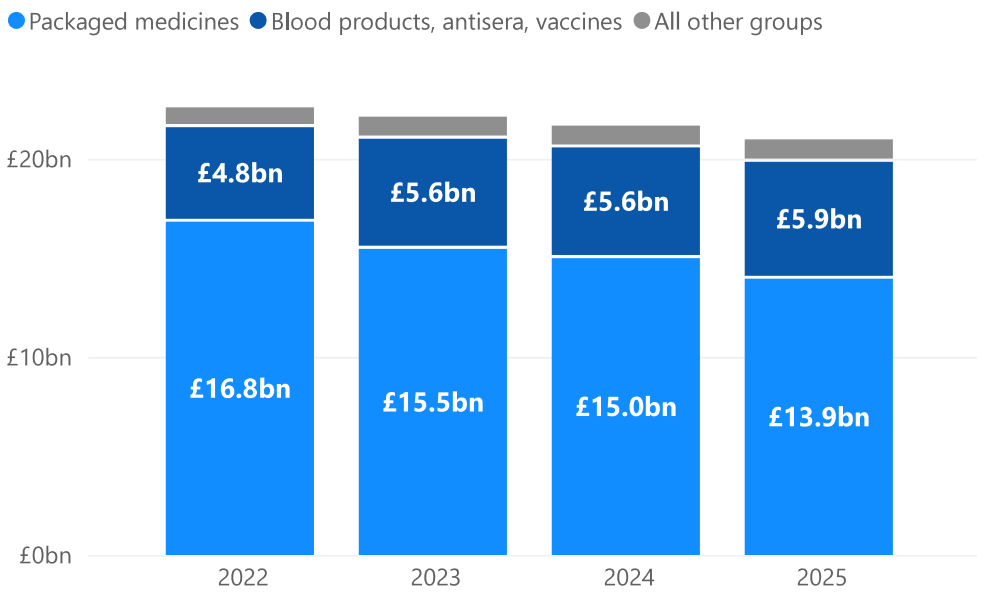


Source: HMRC Overseas Trade in Goods Statistics, pharmaceutical products (HS chapter 30), Jan 2022 to Jul 2026.
Buyers: top 5 over the period. Suppliers: top 4, plus France, Spain and Ireland. 2022 and 2023 import shares include eight months of unusually large imports from Israel.

Product groups and value per kg

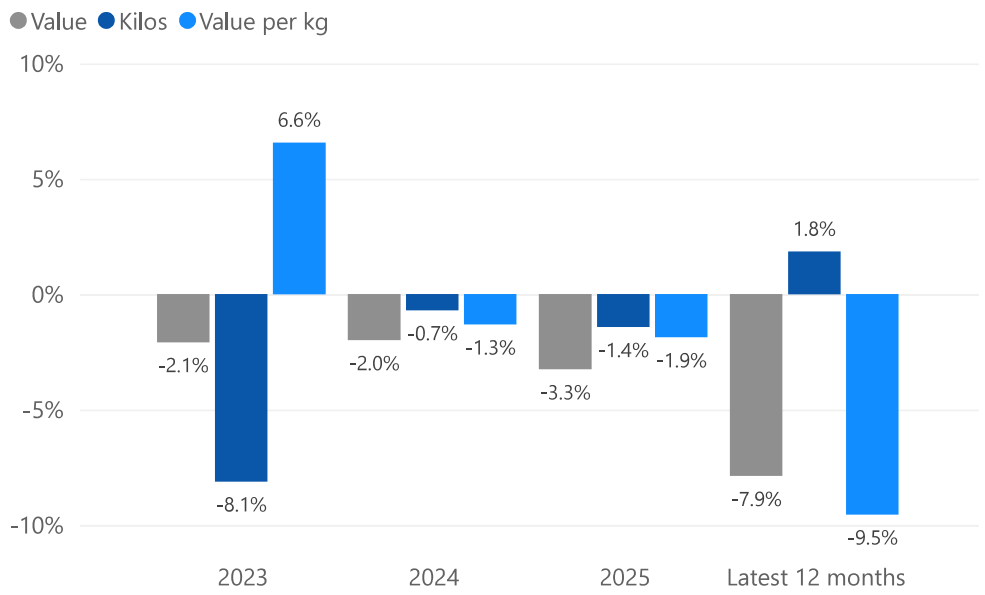
Packaged medicines fell £2.9bn, blood products rose £1.1bn

UK medicine exports by product group, 2022 to 2025. 2026 is left out (part year).



The latest fall in export value is in value per kg, not kilos

UK medicine exports, change from a year earlier. Latest 12 months is to Jul 2026.



Source: HMRC Overseas Trade in Goods Statistics, pharmaceutical products (HS chapter 30), Jan 2022 to Jul 2026. Not adjusted for inflation.
Value per kg is value divided by weight. It is not a price, because it also moves with the mix of medicines.